FREE COMPANION TO THE BOOK

Managing Online Accounts After a Death

Printable templates and sample letters from the appendix, with more room to write.
For your own use; copy as often as you need.

Never write passwords, PINs, recovery codes, recovery phrases or full Social Security numbers into these templates. A printed list gets left on a table, lent out and forgotten.

Contents: A. Key dates · B. Roles and documents · C. Master list · D. Contact log · E. Device and storage list · F. Subscription tracker · G. Before closing an account · H. Questions for professional help · I. Sample letters · J. Official help pages

The sample letters are suggestions, not legal advice. Provider forms come first. This material provides general information for the United States; it is not legal, tax or financial advice.

Corrections and updates: **callidus-am.de/en/digital-estate/**

TEMPLATE A

Key dates

Urgent item	Deadline	Where the deadline comes from	Who takes care of it	Follow-up date	Done
Notify one credit bureau (step 6)					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐

TEMPLATE B

Roles and documents

Person	Role (step 4)	Accounts or actions covered	Authority confirmed by / date	Proof (letters, affidavit, trust papers) and where it is kept

A role does not cover everything. Write down which accounts or actions each confirmation covers.

Certified death certificates: received _____ · ordered _____ · given to: _____

TEMPLATE C

Master list

Account	Goal (save first / stop charges / close later / keep for now)	Who handles it	Role	Authority for next action	Data at risk? (yes / no / unknown)	Amount and frequency	Next step	Next date	Status
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					
				☐ confirmed ☐ not yet					

TEMPLATE D

Contact log

Date	Provider	How (phone, email, letter, form)	Name / case number	What about	Answer	Next date	Who follows up

TEMPLATE E

Device and storage list

Device or storage	Where it is kept	Charged / charger with it	Owner known?	Access issue (passcode / account access / data request pending)	Next step
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		
		☐	☐ yes ☐ unclear		

TEMPLATE F

Subscription tracker

Service	Billed through	Amount and frequency	Decision (keep for now / cancel / ask first)	Requested on	Confirmed end date	Next statement checked
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐

Before you act on "cancel", confirm who may cancel and check what happens to stored data (template G).

TEMPLATE G

Before closing an account

Can't be undone. Google says it cannot process a request for account content after the account is closed.[^US-T06] Check each provider's own rules before you ask for closure.

Account: _____

- ☐ I asked the provider what closing would do to money, digital purchases and stored data.
- ☐ Any data request is finished, and the saved files were opened and checked.
- ☐ The person asking for closure has authority for this account: _____
- ☐ I checked the provider's help page on what closing does (date: _____).
- ☐ The person with authority checked what must be kept for the estate, taxes or a possible dispute.
- ☐ Open questions: _____ (if anything is still unclear, don't ask for closure yet)
- ☐ Decision written down on _____ by _____

TEMPLATE H

Questions for professional help

Roles and authority - Who can be appointed to handle the estate, and how? - Does our state have a small estate process that fits our situation? - Which papers will providers accept from us?

Access to accounts - Has our state adopted a law on fiduciary access to digital assets? - What would a court order need to say for [provider]? - Is a court order worth the cost for this account?

Debts and money - Who is responsible for these bills? Should anything be paid now, and from which funds? - What happens to joint accounts and accounts with a named beneficiary?

Taxes (for a CPA or enrolled agent) - Which tax returns need to be filed for the person and the estate? - What about a refund, Form 1310, or returns that were not filed for earlier years?

Business (if any) - Who owns each business account, and who may act for the business?

TEMPLATE I

Three sample letters

Provider forms come first. Use these letters only where a provider asks for a written request or has no form. Change the wording to fit what is true for you. Don't claim a role you don't have. Send documents only through the provider's own submission route, and only the ones it asks for. A letter does not guarantee that the account is kept; write the request, any deadline and your follow-up date in template D.

1. Notice of death and question about the process

[Your name]
[Your address, phone, email]
[Date]

To: [Provider], [department, if known]
Re: Account of [full name of the person who died], [account email, phone number or customer number]

I am writing to tell you that [full name] died on [date].
I am [your relationship, e.g. "her son"]. [Choose what is true: "I have been appointed personal representative of the estate." / "I am named as executor in the will. The court has not appointed me yet." / "No one has been appointed yet." / "I do not yet know who is authorized to act."]

Please tell me:
1. What is your process for the account of a customer who died?
2. Who may make requests about the account, and which documents do you need?
3. How should documents be sent to you?

I am not asking you to close the account. Please tell me whether the account and its data can be preserved while you review this, and whether any deadline applies.
Please send your reply to the address above and include a case number.

[Signature]

2a. Request for data

If it is not clear yet who may request data, send letter 1 first.

Re: Account of [full name], [account identifier], case number [if any]

As [your role], I am asking for a copy of the following data from the account, if you can provide it: [e.g. "photos stored in the account"].
Documents sent through your verified submission method: [only the documents you asked for, e.g. "certified copy of the death certificate; letters of administration dated _____"].
If you need anything else, please tell me what and why.
I am not asking for closure. Please tell me whether the account can be preserved while this request is open.

2b. Request for closure

Before you send this: complete template G. Confirm your authority, and ask the provider what closing would do to money, digital purchases and stored data. If anything is unclear, send letter 1 instead.

Re: Account of [full name], [account identifier], case number [if any]

I am asking you to close this account in my role as [confirmed role].
All data requests we need are complete.
Please confirm in writing when the closure takes effect.
Documents sent through your verified submission method: [list].

3. Follow-up

Re: Account of [full name], case number [number]

On [date] I sent a request about this account [by mail / through your form / by email]. I have not received a reply.
Please tell me the status of the request, and whether anything is missing.
[If you received an answer without a reason:] Please tell me in writing which document or information is missing, and who can make this request.

J

Official help pages

Checked November 2026. Individual check dates are in the sources list of the book.

Addresses change. If a link no longer works, search the provider's help center for "deceased" or "passed away".

Government and consumer help

Social Security: when someone dies

https://www.ssa.gov/personal-record/when-someone-dies

Social Security: lump-sum death payment

https://www.ssa.gov/personal-record/when-someone-dies/lump-sum-death-payment

USA.gov: death certificates

https://www.usa.gov/death-certificate

CFPB: debt after a death

https://www.consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/does-a-persons-debt-go-away-when-they-die-en-1463/

CFPB: submit a complaint

https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/

IRS: final income tax returns of a deceased person

https://www.irs.gov/individuals/file-the-final-income-tax-returns-of-a-deceased-person

IRS: identity theft guide (deceased persons)

https://www.irs.gov/identity-theft-central/identity-theft-guide-for-individuals

IdentityTheft.gov: recovery steps

https://www.identitytheft.gov/Steps

Legal Services Corporation: find legal aid

https://www.lsc.gov/about-lsc/what-legal-aid/i-need-legal-help

Tech providers

Apple: Legacy Contact

https://support.apple.com/en-us/102631

Apple: deceased family member's account

https://support.apple.com/en-us/102431

Google: request regarding a deceased user

https://support.google.com/accounts/troubleshooter/6357590?hl=en

Google: Inactive Account Manager

https://support.google.com/accounts/answer/3036546?hl=en

Microsoft: when someone has died

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/accounts-billing/manage/accessing-outlook-com-onedrive-and-other-microsoft-services-when-someone-has-died

Yahoo: account owner passes away

https://help.yahoo.com/kb/account/options-yahoo-account-owner-passes-sln2021.html

Dropbox: someone who passed away

https://help.dropbox.com/account-settings/access-account-of-someone-who-passed-away

Money and phone

PayPal: deceased relative

https://www.paypal.com/us/cshelp/article/how-do-i-close-the-paypal-account-of-a-deceased-relative-help220

Venmo: deceased relative

https://help.venmo.com/cs/articles/how-to-close-the-venmo-account-of-a-deceased-relative-vhel371

Coinbase: deceased family member's account

https://help.coinbase.com/en/coinbase/managing-my-account/other/how-do-i-gain-access-to-a-deceased-family-members-coinbase-account

Verizon: deceased account handling

https://www.verizon.com/support/deceased-account-handling/

AT&T: deceased customer (wireless)

https://www.att.com/support/article/wireless/KM1113355/

T-Mobile: deceased family member

https://www.t-mobile.com/support/account/cancel-an-account-of-a-deceased-family-member

Social media and shopping

Facebook: memorialization

https://transparency.meta.com/policies/community-standards/memorialization/

Instagram: memorialization

https://help.instagram.com/231764660354188

X: deceased family member

https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/contact-x-about-a-deceased-family-members-account

LinkedIn: deceased member

https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a1336663/memorialize-or-close-the-account-of-a-deceased-member

Amazon: bereavement support

https://www.amazon.com/gp/help/customer/display.html?nodeId=TzcJJiVFnIi3pG2yDA